

MANCHILD



All of us collectively grooved to Manchild all of summer 2025. By choice or not, is pointless. What one cannot fail to notice is the surge of defensive stances on how derogatory the album cover seemingly was.

Some argued it was “regressive.” Others questioned what it implied about modern masculinity. But the intensity of the discourse revealed something more interesting than outrage:

It proved the cover had done exactly what strong pop marketing is designed to do — provoke conversation before the music even arrives.

When Sabrina Carpenter finally revealed the titular track, the strategy crystallized. The ambiguity of the cover, the charged language, the cultural timing — all of it built anticipation. The audience wasn’t just waiting for a song; they were waiting for clarification.

Rather than positioning the image as an attack, it can be read as commentary — a satirical nod to a familiar archetype. The term “manchild” isn’t an indictment of men at large, but a critique of a specific behavior pattern that’s widely recognized in dating culture.

By leaning into the term, Sabrina reframed it. What could have been interpreted as antagonistic became self-aware and culturally literate.

